

Impersonal Passive in Networking

Introduction

The impersonal passive is often used in professional and technical contexts to make statements sound neutral and focus on the action or idea rather than the person. It's useful when:

- You don't know who performed the action.
- The subject isn't important.
- You want to sound professional or technical.

How It Works

Structure:

It + is/was + past participle + that/infinitive clause

Examples in Networking:

1. Informal: *"People say that latency is the main problem."*
 - Formal: *"It is said that latency is the main problem."*
2. Informal: *"They think that bandwidth affects performance."*
 - Formal: *"It is thought that bandwidth affects performance."*

Activity 1: Solving the Mysteries of the Data Center

You are investigators trying to organize anonymous reports about network problems. Your task is to transform the following informal statements into impersonal passive sentences.

Task:

Rewrite these statements:

1. *"People believe that packet loss is causing video call issues."*
 - **Your Answer:** _____
2. *"Everyone knows that bandwidth is crucial for streaming."*
 - **Your Answer:** _____
3. *"They say that load balancing improves system reliability."*
 - **Your Answer:** _____

Activity 2: "The Technology Crystal Ball"

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=u5vETw6utfY>

Pretend you're technical futurists making predictions about networking trends. Use the **impersonal passive** to write formal predictions.

Examples:

1. "5G will improve latency worldwide."
 - "It is expected that 5G will improve latency worldwide."
2. "AI will transform network security."
 - "It is believed that AI will transform network security."

Your Task:

Write 2-3 predictions about the future of networking using the impersonal passive.

- *It is thought that...*
- *It is believed that...*
- *It is said that...*

Activity 3: Rumor Board (Networking Edition)

Match each informal statement to its formal equivalent.

Informal Statement	Formal Passive Equivalent
1. "People think that jitter affects video calls."	a) "It is known that bandwidth affects speed."
2. "Everyone knows that bandwidth affects speed."	b) "It is believed that jitter affects video calls."
3. "They say that latency causes delays."	c) "It is said that latency causes delays."

Activity 4: Escape Room – "Network in Crisis"

Your company's network is failing! Solve the following tasks to fix the issues.

Task 1: Complete the sentences.

1. "_____ (say) that packet loss is the main problem."
2. "_____ (know) that high latency affects video calls."

3. " _____ (believe) that load balancing optimizes performance."

Task 2: Use all completed sentences to write a report explaining the network issues.

Activity 5: Networking Debate – "It Is Said That..."

Prepare arguments using the **impersonal passive** for one of these statements:

1. *"It is believed that cloud computing will replace traditional servers."*
2. *"It is said that 5G will eliminate latency problems forever."*
3. *"It is thought that AI will make networks self-healing."*

Task:

- Write 2-3 sentences supporting or opposing the statement using the impersonal passive.
- Example:
 - *"It is said that cloud computing reduces costs significantly."*
 - *"It is thought that traditional servers are more reliable in some cases."*

Recap: Impersonal Passive Cheat Sheet

Use this guide to help you form sentences:

- **General formula:** *It + is/was + past participle + that/infinitive clause.*
- **Key verbs:** *It is said... / It is thought... / It is believed... / It is expected...*
- **Professional tone:** Focus on the idea, not the person!